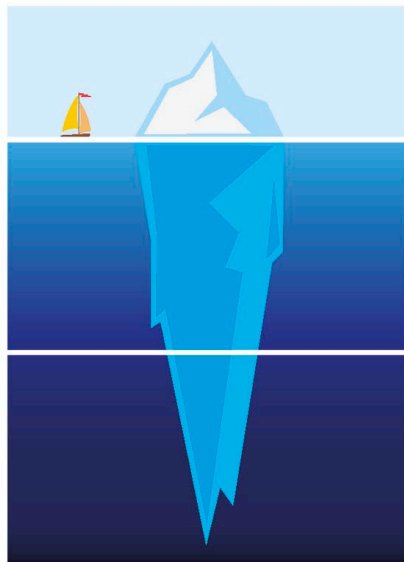


The deep web

The deep web is the segment of the internet that is hidden. It is sometimes called the invisible internet as the majority of people don't ever go there, or know it exists.

Deep vs dark

The deep web contains webpages that can't be found with regular search engines. These webpages include private social media accounts and corporate databases. However, the dark web is even harder to access. A special browser, such as Tor, that masks a computer's identity is required to access these heavily restricted websites.



SEE ALSO

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Staying safe online **186–187** ▶

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◁ Regular web

Between 90 and 99 per cent of the internet is hidden from view. The remaining 1–10 per cent is what people browse every day.

◁ Deep web

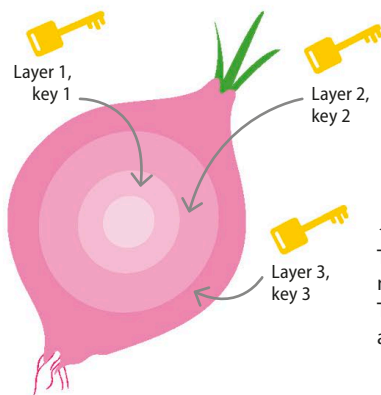
Between 90 and 99 per cent of the internet is believed to be the deep web. To get to a deep web webpage, you need to know a specific URL as the webpage will not be listed on traditional search engines.

◁ Dark web

The most restricted part of the deep web is called the dark web, and users need special web browser software to reach it. A lot of criminal activity happens there as it is completely anonymous.

Onion routing

Tor, short for "the onion router", is software that allows users to browse the internet without being identified. Normally, an eavesdropper can use a variety of ways of tracing what a user does online. Tor hides data with encryption, and uses complicated routing to confuse eavesdroppers. People monitoring a network will only see packets coming in and out, but they won't know which server the user is contacting. The Tor network has its own computers, called nodes, that are run by volunteers around the world.



◁ Layered encryption

The browser encrypts a message multiple times using different keys. These specially encrypted packets are called "onions".

